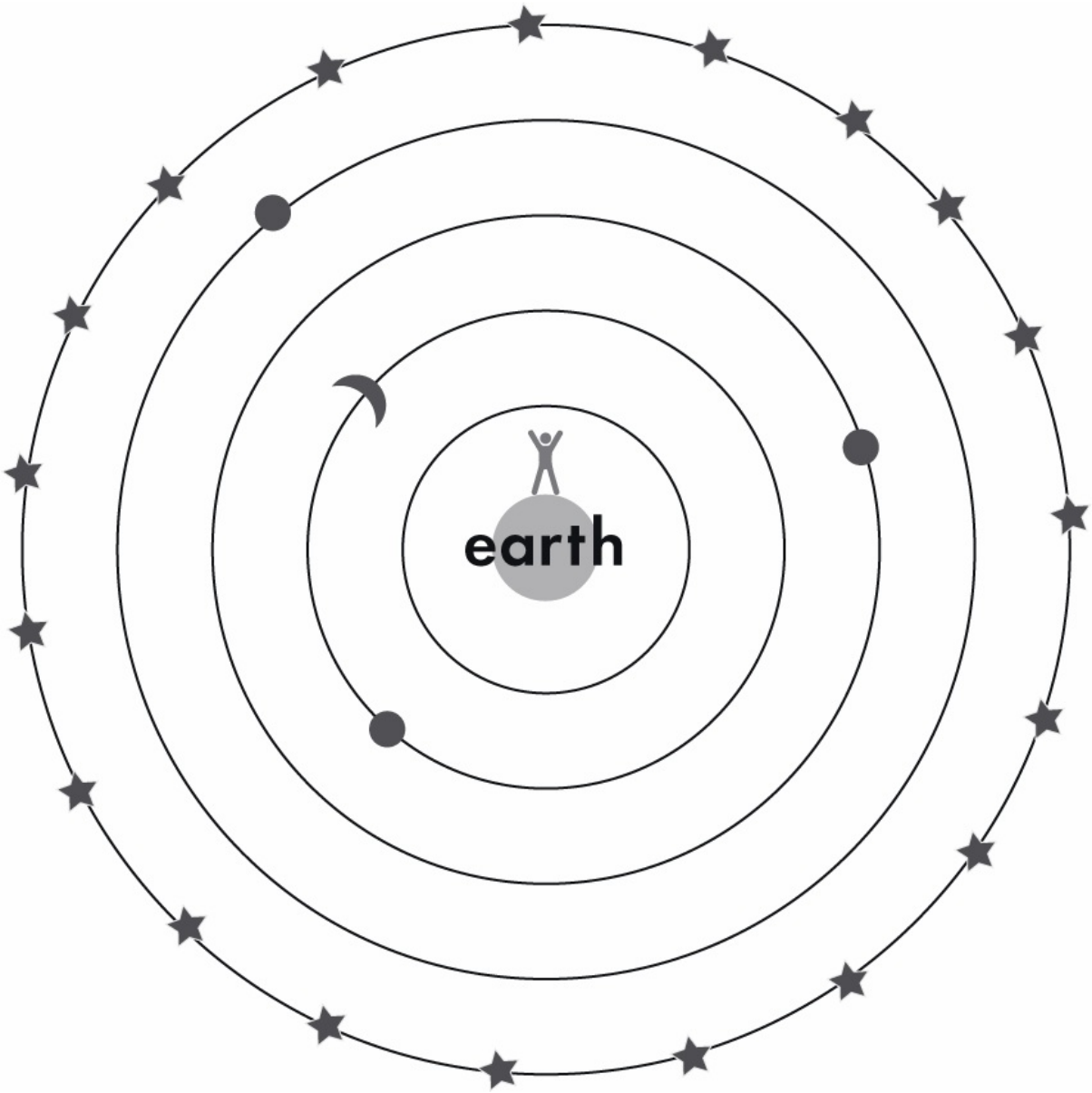


And this cosmos, as described by Aristotle in his work *On the Heavens*, is the image of the world that remained characteristic of Mediterranean civilizations right up until the end of the Middle Ages. It's the image of the world that Dante and Shakespeare studied at school.

The next leap was accomplished by Copernicus, inaugurating what has come to be called the great scientific revolution. The world, for Copernicus, is not so very different from Aristotle's: